Statement on Equity, Diversity and Inclusion

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My own path. I grew up in Cape Town, and South Africa's diversity taught me early that while talent is universal, opportunities are not. My own route into mathematics ran through the national olympiad programme, whose camps showed me mathematics far beyond the school syllabus, and at every stage since I have been fortunate to have supportive mentors and communities. As a PhD student, especially during the pandemic, I found how isolating research can be, with almost all of my work done with my supervisor alone. Both experiences shape what I try to do: open the door to mathematics for students who have the curiosity but not the opportunity, and make the community they enter one where they belong, not in spite of their background or identity, but with those parts of themselves welcomed and celebrated.

Outreach. At school I tutored through Tutonic, a volunteer scheme offering free tutoring to any student who asked for help. From 2015 to 2019 I coached at South Africa's national mathematics camps: the December camps held at universities for promising school students from across the country, and the camps that select the teams for the International and Pan-African Mathematical Olympiads, for which I also set and marked tests and monthly assignments. My aim there was not only to coach but to make the camps a place where every student felt safe to ask questions and offer ideas. I also served on the scientific committee of the South African Programming Olympiad, and more recently was a team guide at the 2024 International Mathematical Olympiad and led Warwick's teams at two international university competitions.

Community. In June 2025 I took part in Rethinking Number Theory, a research workshop built on the idea that number theory should be accessible and enjoyable to everyone. Our group of six studied the repellent properties of perfect powers on partition functions, and the project became a joint paper (*Res. Math. Sci.*, 2026). After a PhD spent mostly working with my supervisor alone, it showed me how much a deliberately welcoming structure changes how research is done and who takes part.

Teaching and mentoring. For three years at Warwick I met small groups of first-year students twice a week. The move to university mathematics is where many capable students, especially those without a strong school background in proof, lose confidence; I learned to ask exactly where a student was stuck rather than show a solution, and to make sure a session was not run by its most confident participant. In my Master's course at Charles University I keep the course materials on a public webpage[1], and in oral examinations I ask students why each step is needed, which rewards understanding over polish. I have supervised a Bachelor's thesis and a summer project, and advised students on their talks at our department's autumn school (54 participants).

Open mathematics. As an Associate Editor of the OEIS and the LMFDB I help maintain free resources that anyone can use and contribute to. Many OEIS contributors are students or mathematicians outside universities, and I review their submissions with the same care as any professional's. I make my own databases and code public, and teach with free software (SageMath, PARI/GP), so that computation needs no licence or institutional access.

Future plans. First, I will offer undergraduate research projects built on computation and the LMFDB, which need few prerequisites and produce real data, and I will advertise them widely and invite students from groups underrepresented in mathematics to apply. Second, I would like to bring the RNT model home, by running small collaborative reading or research groups for students and early-career researchers in which nobody works alone. Third, I would like to strengthen links with mathematics in Africa, for example by teaching a short course or supervising essays at the African Institute for Mathematical Sciences (AIMS), or by lecturing at a CIMPA research school on computational number theory.

[1] Course webpage: https://rvisser7.github.io/nmal431/